Imposter Syndrome

Everyone feels like a phony sometimes, and it is OK

Angela Dugan
Vice President, Client Delivery
Red Foundry

Level: All are Welcome!

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One word check-in

pho·ny

/ˈfōnē/

informal

adjective

1. not genuine; fraudulent.
   "I thought your accent was a bit phony"
   synonyms: bogus, false, fake, fraudulent, spurious; More

noun

1. a fraudulent person or thing.
   synonyms: impostor, sham, fake, fraud, charlatan; More

> Impostor syndrome[1] is a psychological phenomenon in which people are unable to internalize their accomplishments. Despite external evidence of their competence, those with the syndrome remain convinced that they are frauds and do not deserve the success they have achieved. Proof of success is dismissed as luck, timing, or as a result of deceiving others into thinking they are more intelligent and competent than they believe themselves to be.

- WIKIPEDIA

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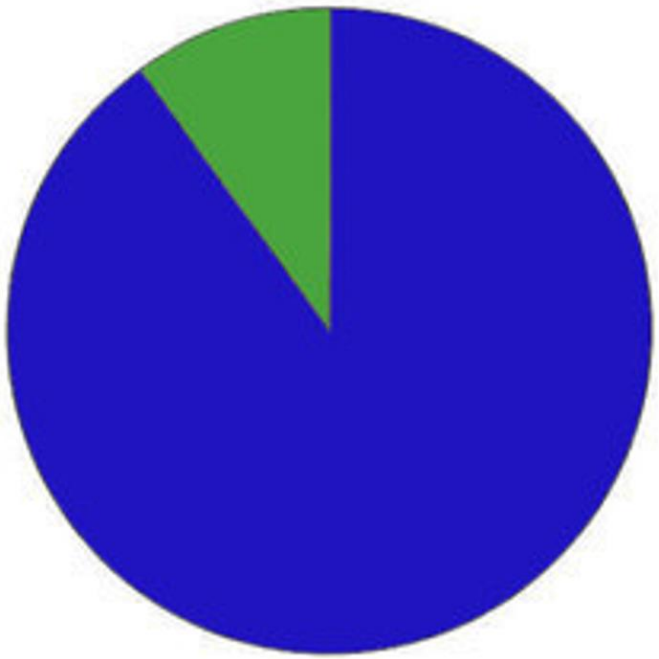
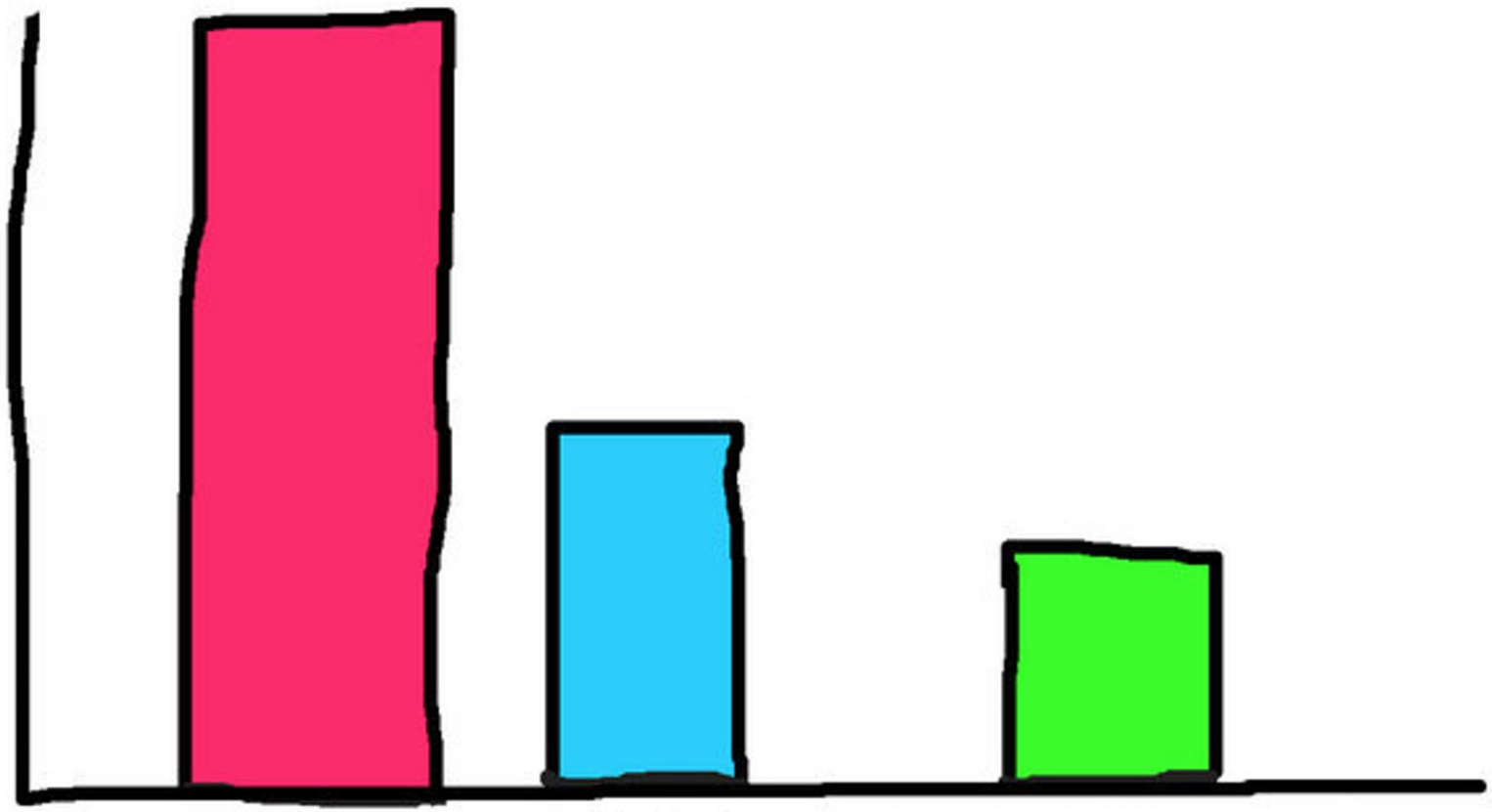
How are you feeling about this topic right now?

ALL COMPLIMENTS YOU RECEIVE:

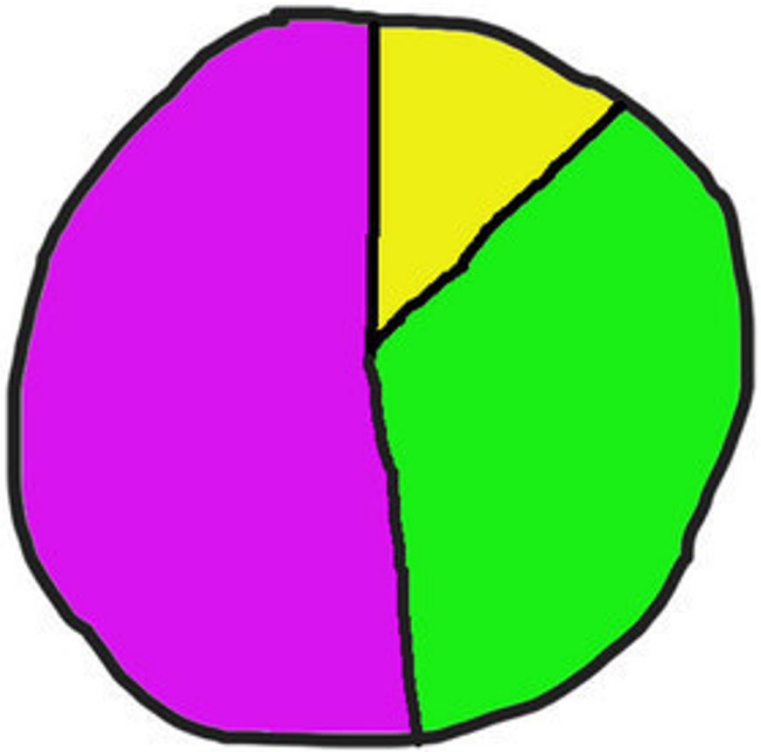
THOUGHTS YOU HAVE ON THE FIRST DAY OF A NEW JOB:



THOUGHTS YOU HAVE WHENEVER YOU NEED TO SUCCEED AT YOUR JOB:



THINGS YOU BEAT YOURSELF UP FOR:



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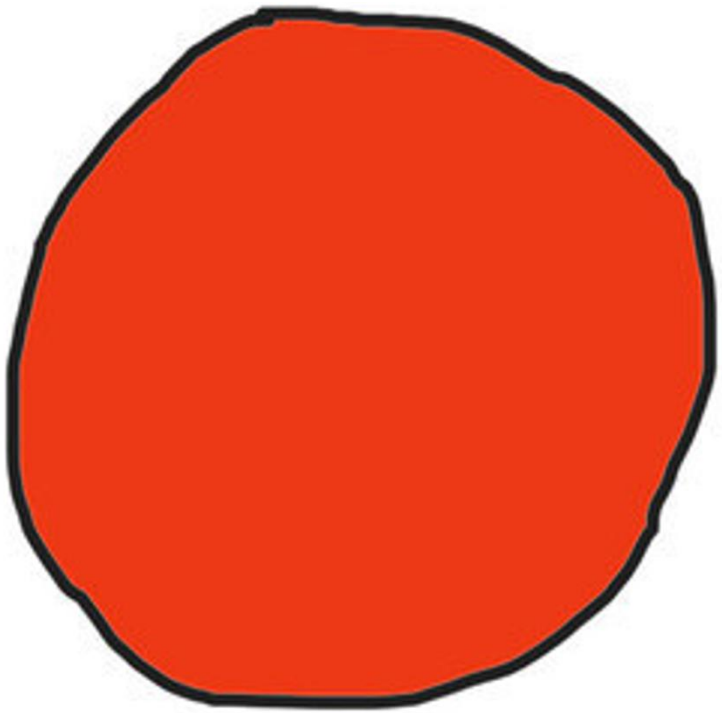
What do you beat yourself up for?

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

TYPES OF PEOPLE WHO CAN HAVE IMPOSTOR SYNDROME:



Angela Dugan

(she/her)

Vice President, Product Delivery
Red Foundry

Hi, my name is Angela

I feel like and Imposter too sometimes!

Values = Connection | Authenticity | Service to Others

Passion = Helping humans who help other humans to be the best humans they can be

Location = Chicago

Fun facts = Obsessed with Halloween; Raises chickens

Email = aDugan@redfoundry.com

URL = www.duganstrategic.com, www.redfoundry.com

Insta = OakParkGirl

LinkedIn = https://www.linkedin.com/in/andugan/

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Professional Scrum Master

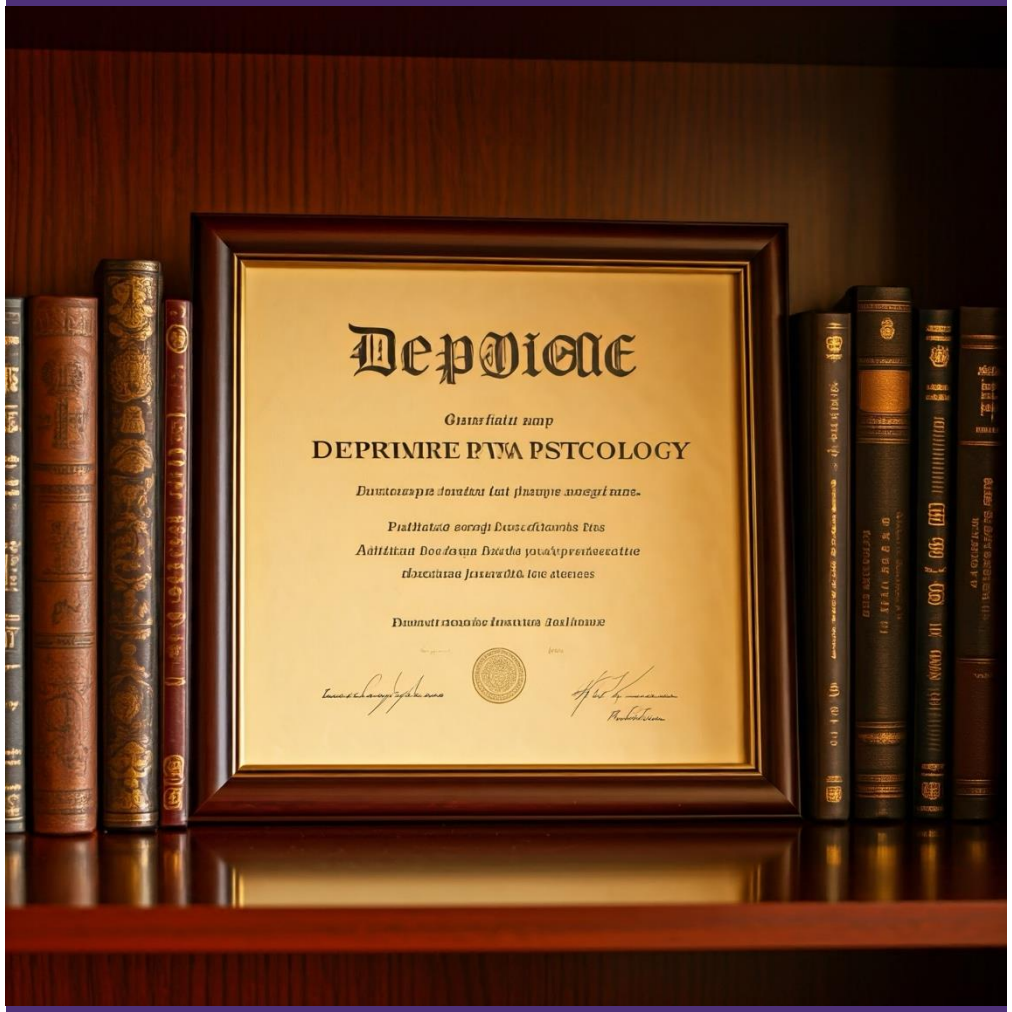
scrum Developer

MVP Microsoft Most Valuable Professional

> Impostor syndrome[1] is a psychological phenomenon in which people are unable to internalize their accomplishments. Despite external evidence of their competence, those with the syndrome remain convinced that they are frauds and do not deserve the success they have achieved. Proof of success is dismissed as luck, timing, or as a result of deceiving others into thinking they are more intelligent and competent than they believe themselves to be.

- WIKIPEDIA

TECH
DAYS 2015
2015-
things
the phone is only one thing
the rest are coming online too



Imposter Syndrome is a phenomenon, not a character flaw

No degree in Psychology needed to work on it

There is no “cure”

By approaching it with lots of grace and awareness, it can be a superpower

How I.S. might manifest in your brain

"I rarely do a project or task as well as I'd like to do it"

"I'm afraid people important to me may find out that I'm not as capable as they think I am"

"Sometimes I'm afraid others will discover how much knowledge or ability I really lack."

"When people praise me for something I've accomplished, I'm afraid I won't be able to live up to their expectations of me in the future"

"Sometimes I feel or believe that my success in my life or in my job has been the result of some kind of error."

"I often compare my ability to those around me and think they are more intelligent than I am"

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The Imposter Test: http://paulineroseclance.com/pdf/IPscoringtest.pdf

LEADE.RS PARIS

Jennifer Marsman
Principal Software Development Engineer, Microsoft

LIGHTNING ROUND:
HACKING OUR WAY TO INNOVATION
#WHFosterYouth
#HackFosterCare

I'm a phony. Are you?

pho·ny also ***pho·ney*** *(fō'nē) adj.* ***pho·ni·er, pho·ni·est***

1.

a. *Not genuine or real; counterfeit: a phony credit card.*

b. *False; spurious: a phony name.*

Who is your Scott?

Who do you envy because of their career, family, social life, whatever?

Who seems to always be “winning at life” in a way that you wish you were?

Who do you compare yourself to?

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Who do you compare yourself to?

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

COMPARISON KILLS CREATIVITY

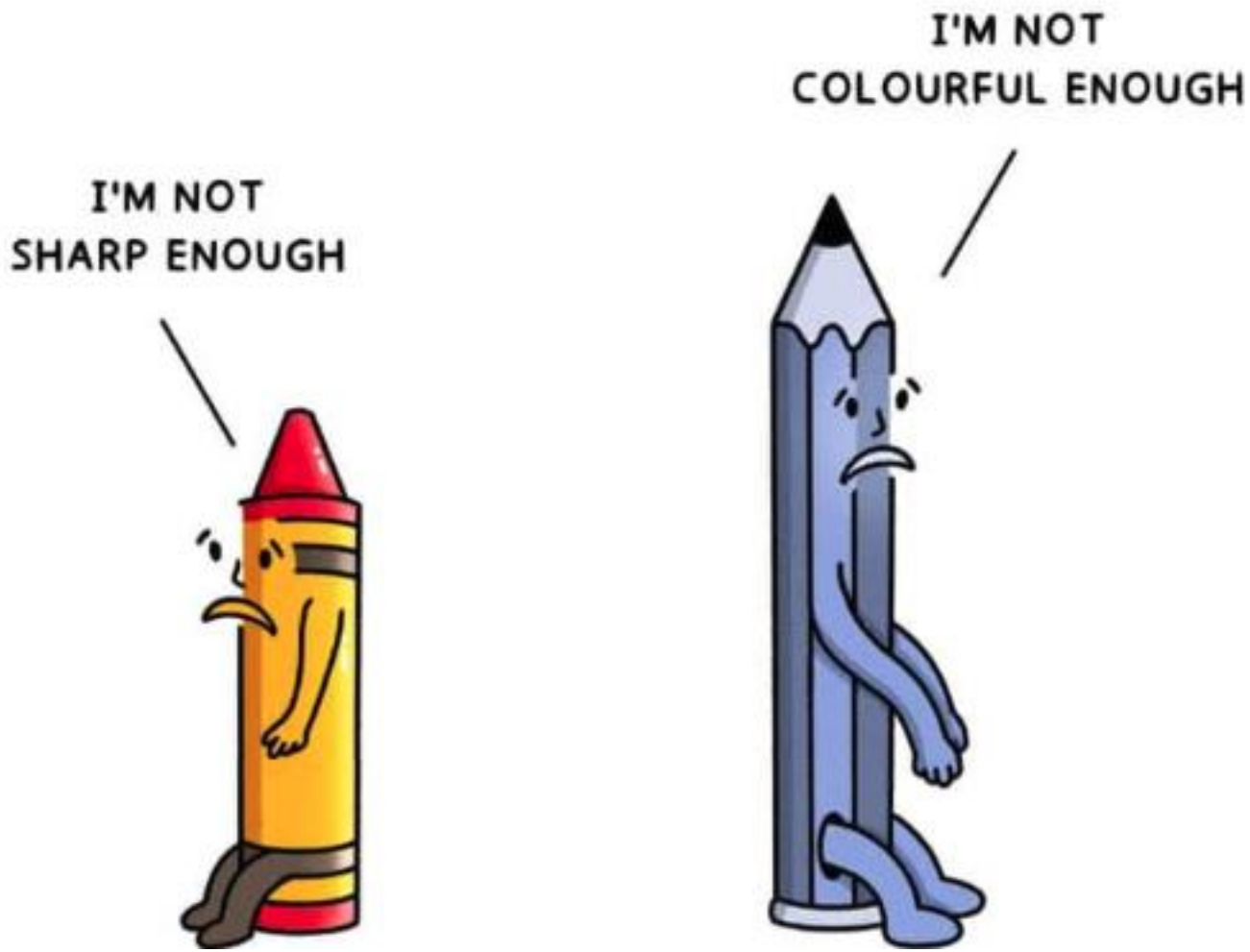

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Image taken from: https://valnelson.com/self-employment/shame-and-vulnerability-attacks/

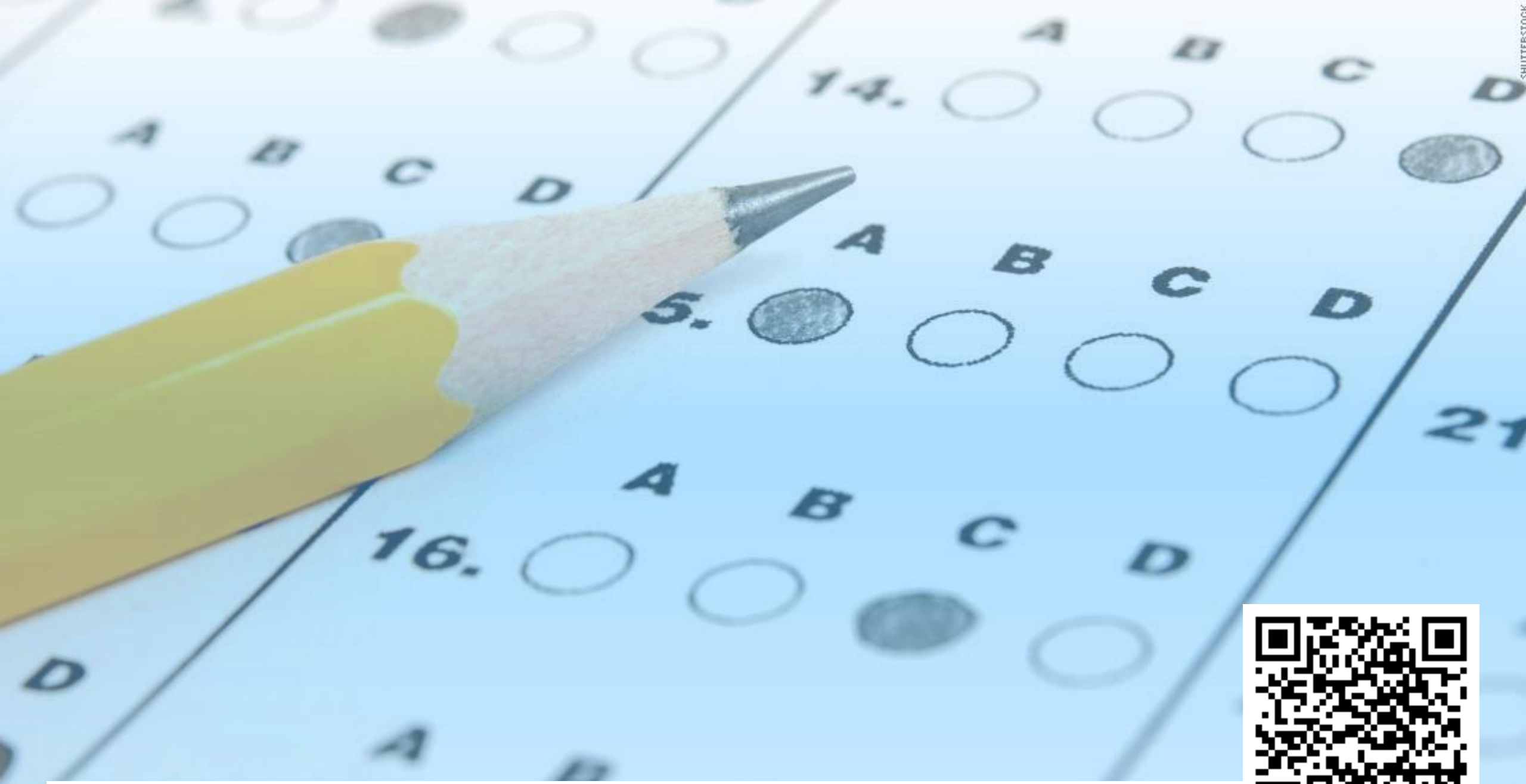
tweet conversation

Scott Hanselman @shanselman

@OakParkGirl see, I always say I need to stop comparing myself to awesome people like you!

Apr 18 3:48 PM

Researchers believe that up to 70% of people have felt the effects of impostor syndrome at some point



The Imposter Test: http://paulineroseclance.com/pdf/IPscoringtest.pdf

1 = NEVER, 2 = RARELY, 3 = SOMETIMES, 4 = OFTEN, 5 = ALWAYS

1. I have often succeeded on a test or task even though I was afraid that I would not do well before I undertook the task.
2. I can give the impression that I'm more competent than I really am.
3. I avoid evaluations if possible and have a dread of others evaluating me.
4. When people praise me for something I've accomplished, I'm afraid I won't be able to live up to their expectations of me in the future.
5. I sometimes think I obtained my present position or gained my present success because I happened to be in the right place at the right time or knew the right people.
6. I'm afraid people important to me may find out that I'm not as capable as they think I am
7. I tend to remember the incidents in which I have not done my best more than those times I have done my best.

1 = NEVER, 2 = RARELY, 3 = SOMETIMES, 4 = OFTEN, 5 = ALWAYS

8. I rarely do a project or task as well as I'd like to do it.
9. Sometimes I feel or believe that my success in my life or in my job has been the result of some kind of error.
10. It's hard for me to accept compliments or praise about my intelligence or accomplishments.
11. At times, I feel my success has been due to some kind of luck.
12. I'm disappointed at times in my present accomplishments and think I should have accomplished much more.
13. Sometimes I'm afraid others will discover how much knowledge or ability I really lack.
14. I'm often afraid that I may fail at a new assignment or undertaking even though I generally do well at what I attempt.

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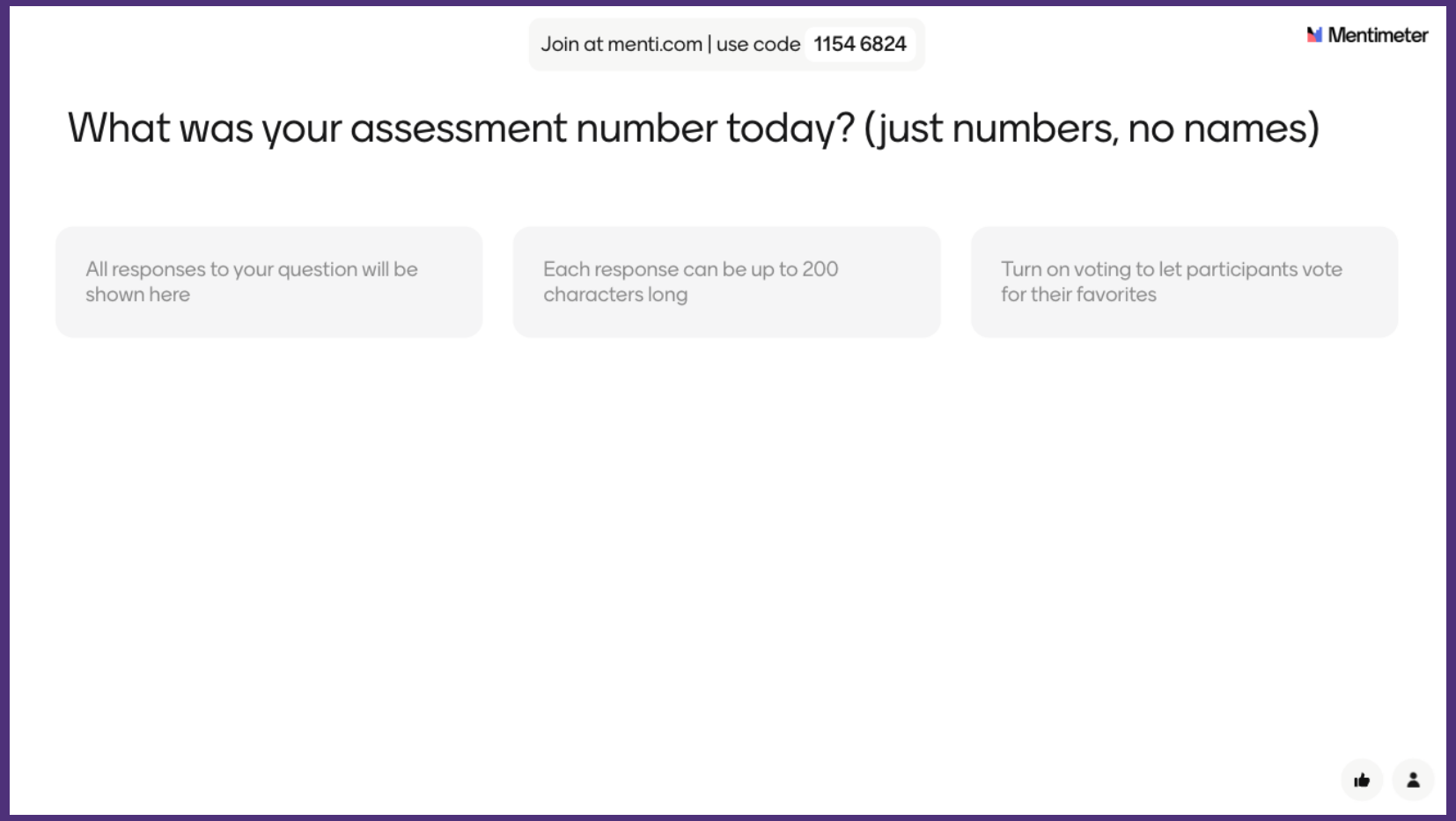
15. When I've succeeded at something and received recognition for my accomplishments, I have doubts that I can keep repeating that success.
16. If I receive a great deal of praise and recognition for something I've accomplished, I tend to discount the importance of what I've done.
17. I often compare my ability to those around me and think they may be more intelligent than I am.
18. I often worry about not succeeding with a project or examination, even though others around me have considerable confidence that I will do well.
19. If I'm going to receive a promotion or gain recognition of some kind, I hesitate to tell others until it is an accomplished fact.
20. I feel bad and discouraged if I'm not "the best" or at least "very special" in situations that involve achievement.



40 or less = respondent has few IS experiences
41 to 60 = respondent has moderate IS experiences
61 to 80 = respondent frequently has Impostor feelings
80+ = respondent often has **intense** IS experiences

IT Manager: 55

Scenic Painter: 71

SAHM: 52

Kindergarten Teacher: 56

Screen Printer: 73

IT Evangelist: 40

IT Consultant: 55

SAHM: 69

Academic Coach: 57

Biology Teacher: 65

Graphic Designer: 74

Lawyer: 89

Librarian: 71

Industrial Plumber: 54

Agile coach: 74

Management Consultant: 67

IT Director: 77

Senior Developer: 67

Freelance Writer: 30

SAHM: 39

Lawyer: 53

Senior Developer: 70

Interior Designer: 55

Angela Dugan: ~~87~~, 65

Network Administrator: 39

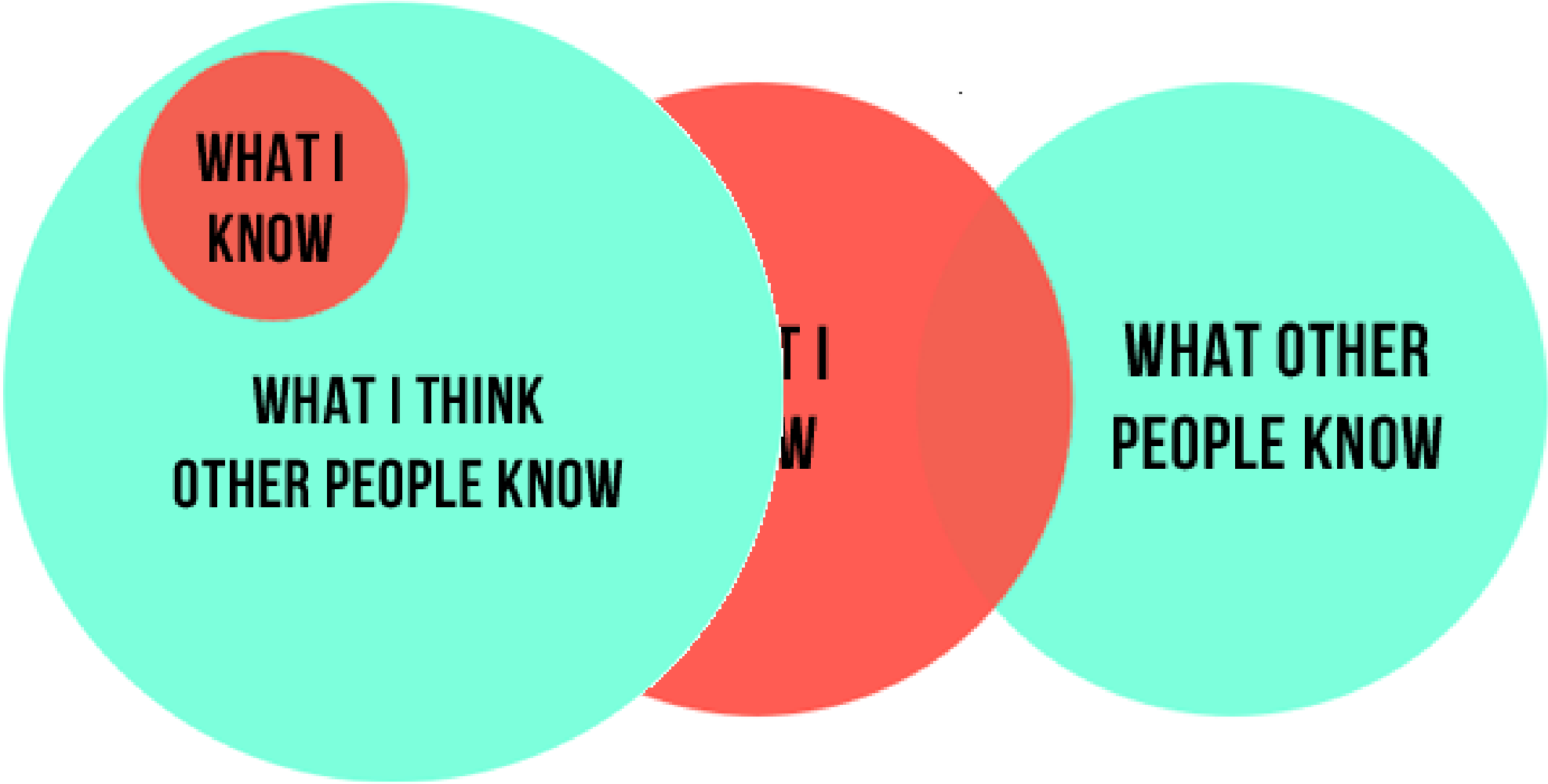
IT Consultant: 77

Audio Engineer: 67

Dietician: 69

“I’m afraid people important
to me may find out that I’m not as capable
as they think I am”

“Sometimes I’m afraid others will discover how much knowledge or ability I really lack.”


WHAT I KNOW
WHAT I THINK OTHER PEOPLE KNOW
T I
W
WHAT OTHER PEOPLE KNOW

So why do we strive to “know it all” anyway?

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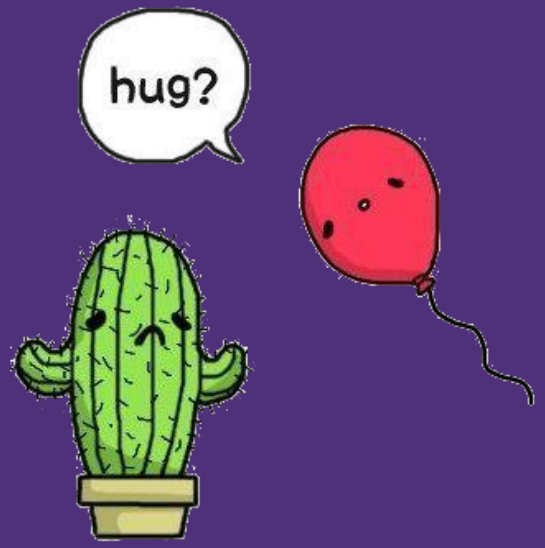
Do any of these inspire feelings of being an Imposter for you?

Speaking in meetings	Peer Reviews of my Work	Sharing my ideas / designs publicly	1:1 with my boss	Performance Reviews
0	0	0	0	0

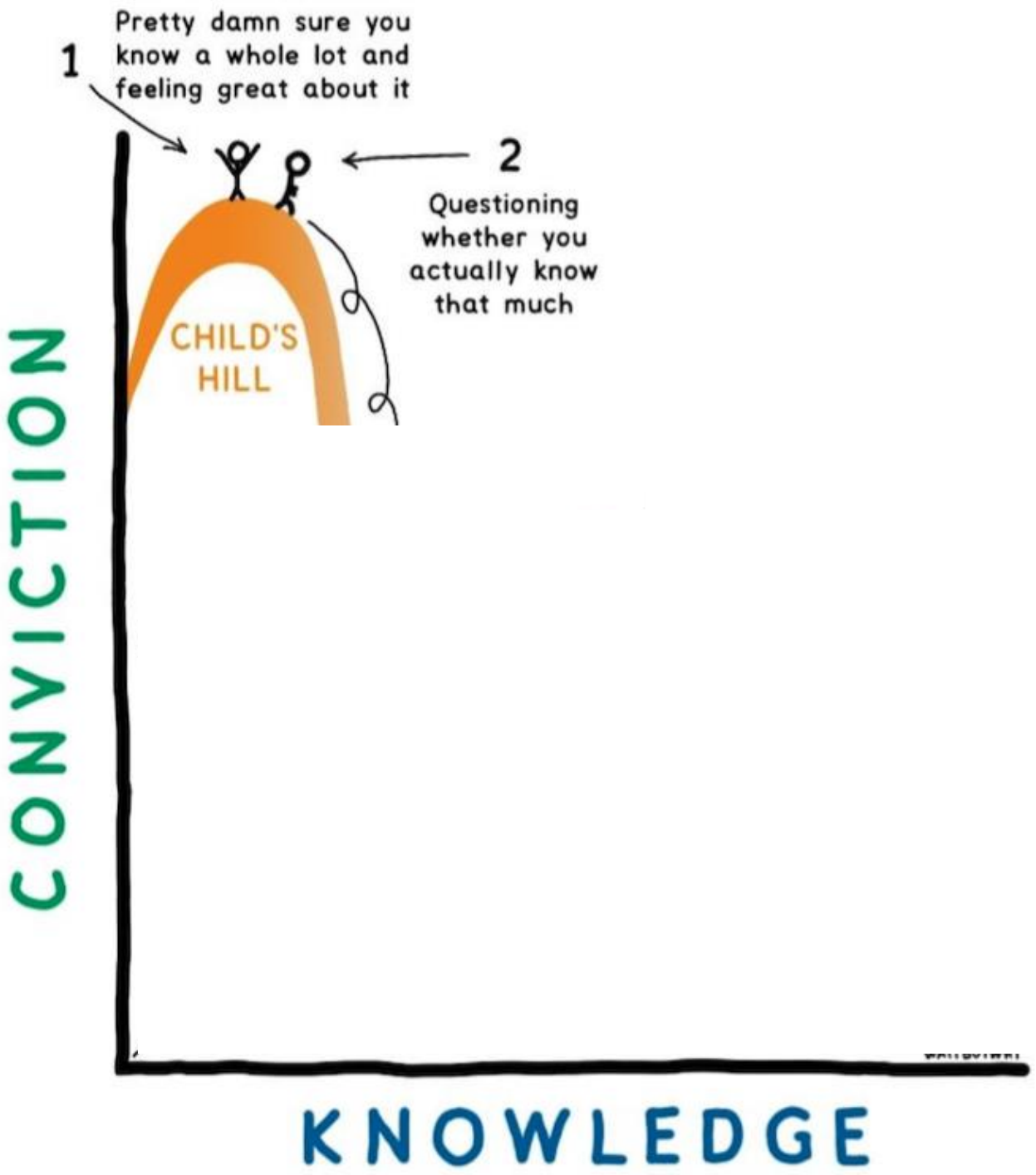
THE STRUGGLE
IS REAL



Embrace the suck

REFRAME

what you are feeling



Adam Grant
@AdamMGrant

Impostor syndrome: “I don't know what I'm doing. It's only a matter of time until everyone finds out."

Growth mindset: "I don't know what I'm doing yet. It's only a matter of time until I figure it out."

The highest form of self-confidence is believing in your ability to learn.

Nothing makes you rethink

what you do and how you act

like having others look up to you!

Thoughts on

Imposter Syndrome

And how AI factors in

AI should be your co-creator and research assistant

Resist the urge to let AI do all the thinking and decision making for you

Be a leader, and set and respect guardrails that keeps AI use productive and supportive

Upskill everyone on AI ethics, safety, and effective prompting to boost confidence and competence

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What will you do differently after this talk?

All responses to your question will be shown here

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0 / 1

Angela Dugan

(she/her)

VicePpresident, Product Delivery
Red Foundry

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